

### Conflict in Burma

From 1823–87, the British fought three wars to gain control of Burma (now Myanmar), and in 1886 the country was proclaimed a province of British India.

political organization brought success, with Sukarno's Indonesian National Party finally forcing independence in 1949.

### French Indochina

The first Europeans in Indochina (Vietnam, Laos, and Cambodia) had been French missionaries, who took Roman Catholicism to Vietnam during the 17th century. The murder of French Christians there provided the pretext for Emperor Napoleon III to invade in 1858, but resistance was strong, both from the Chinese, who claimed sovereignty over Vietnam, and from the indigenous population. In 1863, France took control of southern Vietnam and established a protectorate in Cambodia. Between 1874 and 1884,



## “The loss of America what can repay? New colonies seek for at Botany Bay.”

JOHN FREETH, ENGLISH POET, c. 1731–1808

### Maori *wahaika*

Weapons such as this *wahaika*—a short club made from wood, whale-bone, or stone—were used for close fighting. By the time of the Maori Wars, the Maoris had also acquired firearms.

## AFTER

the French set up more protectorates in northern and central Vietnam. In 1887, these were incorporated, along with Cambodia, in the Union of French Indochina. Territories ruled by Siam (which are now known as Laos) became a protectorate in 1893. The French tried to impose French culture on the Union. However, along with communism, it was Gallic education that inspired the Indochinese to seek the French ideals of *liberté, égalité, and fraternité* (see pp.302–03).

### British Malaya

Britain first established a presence in Malaya in 1786, and in 1826 formed a colony called the Straits Settlements,

which included Malacca and Singapore. During the 19th and early 20th century Britain set up protectorates over a number of Malay states including part of Brunei and North Borneo. By 1914, Britain had colonial control of British Malaya (now known as Malaysia).

The British established highly profitable tin mines and rubber plantations in Malaya. However, rather than exploiting the indigenous population, they imported Chinese labor for the mines, and Indian workers for the plantations, while encouraging the Malays to farm for a living. The result was a more peaceful coexistence than in many other European colonies in Southeast Asia.

**World War II irreversibly altered the balance of world power, and led to the dismantling of the European empires.**

### ASIA AFTER IMPERIALISM

Britain granted commonwealth status to Australia in 1901, and New Zealand in 1907, recognizing their self-government within the empire. British Southeast Asian colonies were made independent between 1957 and 1984. Indonesia became independent from the Dutch in 1949, and in 1954 the French lost Indochina, leading to the division of Vietnam **412–13** >>

### MIXED FORTUNES

After European withdrawal, the Philippines, Indonesia, and Vietnam all experienced civil unrest or war,

while Japan and, later, Malaysia, Singapore, and Indonesia went on to achieve such rapid economic growth that they were dubbed the “**Tiger economies**” **456–57** >>

### AUSTRALIA'S ABORIGINALS

While Southeast Asian independence meant self-representation for indigenous people, the same was not true in Australia. The **Aboriginal population declined** to 60,000 in 1921 and the interwar period saw **renewed confiscation** of land.

In 1938, on the 150th anniversary of European colonization, Aboriginals declared Australia Day, the national holiday, to be a day of mourning.

**SUKARNO, FIRST  
INDONESIAN PRESIDENT**

